

Connecticut State Department of Education

DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2022-23



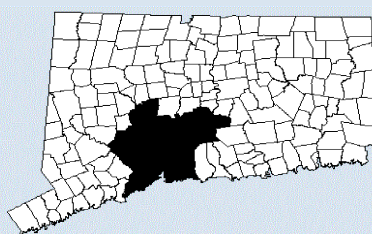
Area Cooperative Educational Services

203-498-6817 • www.aces.org

District Information

Grade Range	PK-12
Number of Schools/Programs	12
Enrollment	1,740
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$44,824
Total Expenditures ¹	\$94,846,533

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2021-22 school year.



Community Information

AdvanceCT Town Profiles provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities at <https://www.advancect.org/site-selection/town-profiles>

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Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2022-23 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality. Complete data suppression guidelines are available at <https://tinyurl.com/SuppressionPolicy>

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2022 Enrollment²

	District		State
	Count	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Female	*	*	48.4
Male	1,027	59.0	51.5
Non-Binary	*	*	0.1
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	0.3
Asian	38	2.2	5.2
Black or African American	582	33.4	12.5
Hispanic or Latino of any race	571	32.8	30.0
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	0.1
Two or More Races	97	5.6	4.5
White	443	25.5	47.5
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	86	4.9	9.7
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	781	44.9	42.4
Students with Disabilities ³	752	43.2	17.1

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	*	*	*	*
Male	418	41.0	189	17.0
Non-Binary	*	*	*	*
Black or African American	241	40.8	127	20.2
Hispanic or Latino of any race	234	42.2	93	15.4
White	140	31.9	41	8.8
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	45	52.9	10	10.8
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	435	47.8	169	17.5
Students with Disabilities	379	49.0	133	15.5
District	669	38.8	283	15.2
State		20.0		7

Number of students qualified as truant under state statute: 729

Number of school-based arrests: 17

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2022-23

Area Cooperative Educational Services

Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	110.0
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	29.0
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	92.0
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	315.7
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	14.0
School Level	18.0
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	3.0
Support Staff	0.0
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	20.5
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	30.5
School Nurses	14.6
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	137.7

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	0.0	0.1
Asian	5	1.6	1.3
Black or African American	19	6.3	4.6
Hispanic or Latino of any race	14	4.6	4.9
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	0	0.0	0.2
White	265	87.2	88.7

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2021-22

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	15.4	13.2

Instruction and Resources

11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School²

	11th		12th	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Black or African American	*	*	19	50.0
Hispanic or Latino of any race	12	*	6	25.0
White	*	*	17	26.2
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	*	*	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	11	40.7	27	42.2
Students with Disabilities	22	45.8	44	33.3
District	22	45.8	44	33.3
State		86.5		94.2

² College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual credit courses.

Students Who Spend 80% or Greater Time with Nondisabled Peers³

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	N/A	N/A
Emotional Disability	N/A	N/A
Intellectual Disability	N/A	N/A
Learning Disability	N/A	N/A
Other Health Impairment	N/A	N/A
Other Disabilities	N/A	N/A
Speech/Language Impairment	N/A	N/A
District	N/A	N/A
State		68.6

³ This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

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Area Cooperative Educational Services

Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	N/A	N/A	2.4
Emotional Disability	N/A	N/A	1.0
Intellectual Disability	N/A	N/A	0.6
Learning Disability	N/A	N/A	6.3
Other Health Impairment	N/A	N/A	3.4
Other Disabilities	N/A	N/A	1.1
Speech/Language Impairment	N/A	N/A	1.9
All Disabilities	N/A	N/A	16.7

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	N/A	N/A	8.1
Private Schools or Other Settings	N/A	N/A	4.7

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2021-22

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$42,733,748	\$20,196	\$12,671
Support services - students	\$17,655,288	\$8,344	\$1,558
Support services - instruction	\$1,878,502	\$888	\$837
Support services - general administration	\$4,042,176	\$1,910	\$463
Support services - school based administration	\$4,526,065	\$2,139	\$1,133
Central and other support services	\$7,114,257	\$3,362	\$716
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$9,216,512	\$4,356	\$1,893
Student transportation services	\$7,679,985	\$3,621	\$1,464
Food services	.	.	\$5
Enterprise operations	.	.	\$186
Total	\$94,846,533	\$44,824	\$20,165

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2021-22

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$8,591,992	16.6	29.0
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$7,748,943	15.0	10.6
Other Salaries	\$17,459,372	33.7	10.1
Employee Benefits	\$12,158,812	23.5	13.1
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$607,430	1.2	5.9
Special Education Tuition	.	.	21.8
Supplies	\$1,797,205	3.5	0.7
Property Services	\$2,584,479	5.0	0.4
Purchased Services For Transportation	\$41,942	0.1	8.1
Equipment	\$776,331	1.5	0.2
All Other Expenditures	\$12,505	0.0	0.1
Total	\$51,779,012	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		54.6	24.9

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2021-22

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	78.2
State	18.8
Federal	3.0
Tuition & Other	.

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2022-23

Area Cooperative Educational Services

Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

	English Language Arts (ELA)		Math		Science	
	Count	DPI	Count	DPI	Count	DPI
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	*	*	*	*
Asian	28	53.5	27	50.9	8	*
Black or African American	393	47.9	385	38.1	135	48.9
Hispanic or Latino of any race	418	52.4	416	45.2	160	50.8
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	*	*	*	*
Two or More Races	73	54.1	72	48.1	23	54.0
White	300	59.2	296	54.4	106	56.3
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	102	54.1	101	45.9	45	52.0
Non-English Learners/Non-Multilingual Learners	1,116	52.6	1,101	45.4	392	51.4
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	523	47.6	514	39.5	214	49.3
Not Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	695	56.6	688	49.9	223	53.5
Students with Disabilities	388	36.0	373	30.4	152	35.3
Students without Disabilities	830	60.6	829	52.2	285	60.1
High Needs	749	46.0	733	38.7	303	46.0
Non-High Needs	469	63.5	469	56.0	134	63.8
District	1,218	52.7	1,202	45.4	437	51.5

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

	NAEP 2022		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
READING			
Connecticut	35	35	50
National Public	32	29	36
MATH			
Connecticut	37	30	32
National Public	35	26	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2022.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard²

	Percent of Students by Grade ³ (%)				All Tested Grades	
	4	6	8	HS	Count	Rate (%)
Sit & Reach	46.3	69.6	73.5	78.0	661	69.6
Curl Up	69.7	83.3	83.1	94.1	658	82.7
Push Up	60.0	62.8	67.3	64.7	653	64.6
Mile Run/PACER	71.9	73.7	74.0	85.7	653	74.6
All Tests - District	31.3	44.8	50.7	53.1	647	46.7
All Tests - State	51.5	46.0	44.1	41.1		45.5

²The Connecticut Physical Fitness Assessment (CPFA) is administered to students in Grades 4, 6, 8 and High School (HS). The health-related fitness scores gathered through the CPFA should be used to educate and motivate children and their families to increase physical activity and develop lifetime fitness habits.

³Only students assessed in all four areas are included in this calculation.

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Area Cooperative Educational Services

Cohort Graduation: Four-Year¹

	2021-22	
	Cohort Count ²	Rate (%)
Black or African American	N/A	N/A
Hispanic or Latino of any race	N/A	N/A
White	N/A	N/A
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	N/A	N/A
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	N/A	N/A
Students with Disabilities	N/A	N/A
District	N/A	N/A
State		88.9

¹ The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

² Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2021-22 school year.

11th and 12th Graders Demonstrating Postsecondary Readiness³

	Participation ⁴	Meeting Benchmark	
	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	20.9	0	0.0
Male	37.2	*	*
Non-Binary	N/A	N/A	N/A
Black or African American	39.1	*	*
Hispanic or Latino	37.2	0	0.0
White	26.3	*	*
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	*	0	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	39.6	*	*
Students with Disabilities	33.3	*	*
District	33.3	*	*
State	95.2		44.3

³ Students demonstrate postsecondary readiness through at least one of the following:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam
- Earning three or more non-remedial college credits cumulatively during high school.

⁴ Participation Rate equals the number of test-takers in 11th and 12th grade divided by the number of students enrolled in those grades, as a percentage.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

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ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

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IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

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College Entrance and Persistence

	Class of 2022	Class of 2021
	Entrance ⁵	Persistence ⁶
	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Female	*	*
Male	*	*
Non-Binary	N/A	N/A
Black or African American	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	*	*
White	*	*
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	*	*
Students with Disabilities	*	*
District	*	*
State	66.1	87.7

⁵ College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

⁶ College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2022-23

Area Cooperative Educational Services

Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	Points Earned	Max Points	% Points Earned	State Average Index/Rate
ELA Performance Index	All Students	52.7	75	35.2	50	70.3	63.9
	High Needs Students	46.0	75	30.7	50	61.3	54.1
Math Performance Index	All Students	45.4	75	30.3	50	60.6	59.7
	High Needs Students	38.7	75	25.8	50	51.6	48.9
Science Performance Index	All Students	51.5	75	34.3	50	68.6	61.6
	High Needs Students	46.0	75	30.7	50	61.3	51.1
ELA Academic Growth	All Students	46.6%	100%	46.6	100	46.6	57.2%
	High Needs Students	43.4%	100%	43.4	100	43.4	52.5%
Math Academic Growth	All Students	51.2%	100%	51.2	100	51.2	61.8%
	High Needs Students	47.7%	100%	47.7	100	47.7	55.5%
Progress Toward English Proficiency	Literacy	68.1%	100%	34.1	50	68.1	55.3%
	Oral	55.5%	100%	27.8	50	55.5	56.1%
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	38.8%	<=5%	0.0	50	0.0	20.0%
	High Needs Students	45.8%	<=5%	0.0	50	0.0	28.5%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	36.7%	75%	24.4	50	48.9	90.4%
	% Meeting Benchmark	1.1%	75%	0.7	50	1.5	44.3%
On-track to High School Graduation		62.0%	94%	33.0	50	66.0	82.4%
4-year Graduation All Students (2022 Cohort)		.	94%	.	.	.	88.9%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2020 Cohort)		.	94%	.	.	.	85.6%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2022)		8.8%	75%	11.7	100	11.7	66.1%
Physical Fitness (estimated part rate) and (fitness rate)		88.4% 46.7%	75%	15.6	50	31.1	93.0% 45.5%
Arts Access		1.4%	60%	1.1	50	2.3	54.5%
Accountability Index				524.2	1250	41.9	

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Achievement Gap Size Outlier?					Y
ELA Performance Index Gap	63.5	46.0	17.5	16.6	
Math Performance Index Gap	56.0	38.7	17.4	18.0	
Science Performance Index Gap	63.8	46.0	17.9	17.8	
Graduation Rate Gap	.	.	.	.	

¹If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

²If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served. Gap calculations are based on unrounded rates.

Subject/Student Group		Participation Rate (%) ³
ELA	All Students	97.2
	High Needs Students	96.0
Math	All Students	95.7
	High Needs Students	93.5
Science	All Students	93.6
	High Needs Students	91.7

³Minimum participation standard is 95%.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

Grade 3 ELA Performance Index for Students with Disabilities:

District: 38.8 State: 49.6

Supporting Resources: <https://public-edsight.ct.gov/Overview/Next-Generation-Accountability-Dashboard#related-links>

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2022-23

Area Cooperative Educational Services

Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

Area Cooperative Educational Services (ACES) is the Regional Educational Service Center in south-central Connecticut dedicated to enhancing and transforming lives through education, innovation, and leadership. Our vision is to create an equitable and socially just world, one life at a time, by engaging the community through Open and Magnet School Parent Choice programs and Minority Teacher Recruitment initiatives.

ACES Family and Community Engagement Specialist has begun the mission to empower, engage families and collaborate with community partners to support strong academic and personal development for all students.

In an effort to support surrounding areas and towns, ACES has begun to hold monthly meetings with partnering districts and visit employment and mental health agencies within the surrounding area in order to increase our knowledge of community-based resources.

1st ACES Resource Fair was developed in an effort to invite in community partners to provide district schools an opportunity to increase their knowledge of community-based resources. It was a huge success with over 45 guests and 14 agencies.

Welcoming walkthroughs were implemented in schools to achieve the goal of ensuring that families, students and community partners felt welcomed.

Family resource rooms were developed in schools to provide resources for families and students. Resources such as hygiene kits, gently used clothing, and school supplies. Family and Community message boards were created to allow families that visit the school to have knowledge of what is going on in the community. For those parents that do not come into the school, in an effort that all families receive the same information a monthly letter is sent out electronically filled with community resources and events.

Family engagement teams were developed in each of the schools. These teams are composed of students, families, school staff and community partners. The team's purpose is to collaborate, plan and implement activities to engage all families.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

As a Regional Educational Service Center, ACES works with our 25-member school districts to reduce academic and social issues stemming from racial, ethnic, and economic isolation. To reduce racial isolation, ACES operates three interdistrict magnet schools enrolling over 1600 students, coordinates several interdistrict collaborative programs, and facilitates Open Choice for our districts.

ACES magnet schools are designed to attract students across many school districts increasing educational opportunities for students of diverse backgrounds to learn alongside one another. Each school reinforces its diversity mission while delivering a high-quality curriculum with a unique academic focus.

Technology allows students to access their learning through multiple resources and has been said to be a great divide for student learning. We provide state-of-the-art technical support and services for all our students to assist them in their education in person and remotely. Most of our schools offer their students a one-to-one laptop/iPad experience. We are working with local universities to develop laboratory classrooms to support action research in our schools and to support the development of teacher cohorts for our member school districts. Our magnet schools have also had the opportunity to participate with other school districts in the interdistrict grant partnerships. Here, our schools' teachers and students work with fellow schools from other communities. We seek opportunities to partner for technology, math, social studies, science, and Language Arts enrichment.

ACES has been instrumental in Minority Teacher Recruitment (MTR) efforts in CT. The MTR Advisory Council has developed and implemented strategies to increase the number of minority educators, including our highly successful annual MTR Job Fair. As a member of the RESC MTR Alliance, ACES played a crucial role in securing funding from the State Pipeline. ACES now operates a Teacher Residency Program to attract and retain teachers of color.

ACES has an agency-wide Diversity Committee and has hired a Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion Director to provide DEI leadership across the agency.

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Area Cooperative Educational Services

Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

ACES is the Regional Educational Service Center for twenty-five school districts in south-central Connecticut. Each local school district appoints a representative to the ACES Governing Board of Education. Our Board works collectively to set a strategic direction for our organization based on the region's educational needs and our school system. ACES operates schools and programs based on these needs, and the Governing Board ensures the equitable allocation of resources among the programs. Each school and program participate in a rigorous budget development process, including ACES Governing Board Approval of resource allocations in every program.

Local funding, State of Connecticut magnet school support, and grant resources are utilized to achieve and enhance equity among our programs. Building level principals and directors meet monthly with ACES Central Administration to discuss issues relating to available resources in meeting their academic goals. This process also assists the district and agency plan for budget development. The budget process includes a committee, the building administrator(s), ACES Central Administration, and the ACES Governing Board.